

Rocco Nardo

COSC 481 Capstone

Supervisor Dr. Lyndsie Ferrara

COFSE Website Redesign and Development Design and Objectives Report

Project Explanation:

I will be designing and implementing a full redesign and modernization of the existing website for the Council of Forensic Science Educators (COFSE). COFSE is an organization of professionals teaching different levels of forensic science that collaborate to share resources that support the future generation of forensic scientists. While the current website contains important and useful information, COFSE feels that both the design and content are outdated.

To modernize the website, I will be creating a new implementation using the Wix platform, primarily through Wix IDE and Wix Velo, which will allow custom coding instead of simply clicking and dragging. In addition to migrating content from the current site to the new site in a more visually appealing way, I will also be implementing features to improve functionality. These features include an online membership application, a secure members-only page, an online payment system, and email communication capabilities. Beyond building the new website, I will also be developing an administrator training document explaining the design decisions and how to make any changes to the website. Overall, I will be redesigning the existing COFSE website to make it more visually engaging and better equipped to aid in the sharing of forensic science resources.

Meetings with Supervisor:

1. January 20, 2026: 10:30am-11:00am

During our first meeting, Dr. Ferrara and I first discussed the current shortcomings of COFSE's website, as well as her goals and expectations for the new website. Beyond improving the visual design, Dr. Ferrara requested several additional features to improve the functionality of the site. We also discussed the importance of making the website easy for COFSE members to make modifications to the site. Once we reviewed the expectations, we discussed the overall

design of the new site, where Dr. Ferrara stated that there is no set design that is currently preferred, but it must be well-organized and include all requested features.

From our discussion, we concluded that the new website will be built using the Wix platform as it provides many of the needed features and ensures easy management. We decided that I will primarily be using Wix IDE and Wix Velo, which allows custom code to further enhance the final product. As there is no specific design requested, I will review current Wix templates to find inspiration to develop a professional and clean design that will be approved by Dr. Ferrara. Lastly, I registered as a COFSE member to gain access to all the resources needed to effectively work on creating a newly designed website.

2. January 29, 2026: 1:00pm-1:30pm

During our meeting, Dr. Ferrara and I reviewed the design and objectives draft that I had prepared based on our prior conversations. First, I walked through each section and asked clarifying questions regarding the expected design and website layout, including which content from the current site is expected to be migrated over and the purpose of some of the pages. Dr. Ferrara then gave some suggestions and modifications to the overall design layout, and I adjusted my design accordingly. After reviewing the report and making minor adjustments, Dr. Ferrara officially approved the report.

In addition, Dr. Ferrara and I set up my accounts for both WordPress and Wix, providing me with full access to both the current and new website. She then explained various tools provided by the Wix platform, and we looked through some sample site templates to gain inspiration on what the new site will look like. Lastly, we agreed that I will begin creating the structure of the new site on Wix, which Dr. Ferrara will review during our next meeting.

Design:

The redesigned COFSE website will ensure clarity and easy navigation on both laptop and mobile devices by using professional colors and fonts, clear headings, structured sections of text, photos, and a strong menu. The menu bar will include quick links to the following pages:

Home Page: The “Home” page will include a photo relating to the council, as well as COFSE’s name, mission, and message from president. In addition, the page will include up-to-date resources/news and general contact information.

About Page: The “About” page will include the current site content explaining what COFSE is in a more modern layout that uses shorter text sections and structured blocks. In addition, the “About” page will include information/pictures of the executive board, as well as a link to the COFSE Bylaws.

Committees Page: The “Committees” page will include brief information about each of the currently listed committees and a link to a designated page for each committee. Each committee page will include information about its duties and members, as well as a potential photo.

Journal Page: The “Journal” page will include current information on the “Journal of Forensic Science Education”, along with a larger and clearer image of the publication. In addition, it will include a link to the JFSE website for additional information.

Delta Delta Epsilon Page: The “DDE” page will provide the current information on DDE in sectioned blocks to make it easy to read, along with any professional photos from DDE. In addition, the page will contain a link to another page where users can fill out a membership form that will be sent directly to DDE.

Links Page: The “Links” page will include all current links, as well as potential one-line summaries of what each link is for.

Membership Page: The “Membership” page will first display current information about the membership, and then a link to log in for existing members and a link to apply for non-existing members. Once members log in, they will be redirected to a members-only page which will include exclusive resources and a section to pay dues. The link to apply will include a form with all the current required information, and the page will not grant access to the members-only page until the application is approved.

A figure expressing the design visually can be found as Figure 1 in the Appendix.

Objectives/Goals:

The following objectives are listed by priority:

1. Migrate and update content from the current site to new Wix site in a visually engaging way
2. Implement an online membership application that allows educators to apply for membership
3. Create a secure members-only page that will include exclusive resources for approved members
4. Integrate online payment functionality for members to securely pay their fees
5. Implement email communication capabilities, like Constant Contact
6. Develop an administrator training document that will review my design and implementation choices and explain how to make any necessary changes/updates
7. Transfer the existing COFSE website domain from current site to redesigned site

Milestones:

Migrate and Update Content (Estimated Time to Complete: 3 Weeks / Week 7)

- Collect and review all current COFSE website content to decide what is being migrated
- Set up Wix environment and develop the structure of pages and links
- Transfer all up-to-date content (text, images, resources) to new Wix site
- Improve formatting, design, and organization of content

Implement Online Membership Application (Estimated Time to Complete: 1.5 Weeks / Week 8.5)

- Design membership application form and required fields
- Develop the membership application using Wix Velo or Wix Forms features
- Configure the storage of submissions and create notifications
- Test membership application functionality

Create Secure Members-Only Section (Estimated Time to Complete: 2 Weeks / Week 10.5)

- Set up Wix page for members only and a secure login system
- Protect page for members only
- Assign access and permissions based on member data
- Upload and design member-exclusive resources

Implement Online Payment Feature (Estimated Time to Complete: 1.5 Weeks / Week 12)

- Research and configure Wix Payments, a feature to easily accept payments from the website, including PayPal and credit cards
- Send notification after payment
- Test secure and reliable transactions and communication

Integrate Email Communication (Estimated Time to Complete: 1.5 Weeks / Week 13.5)

- Research and set up Constant Contact integration, a platform allowing COFSE to send automated emails to members
- Connect member contact information from database
- Test email functionality

Create Administrator Training Document (Estimated Time to Complete: 1 Week / Week 14.5)

- Document website structure and design decisions
- Write step-by-step instructions for updating content
- Provide instructions on managing memberships, payments, and communications

Transfer Existing COFSE Domain (Estimated Time to Complete: 0.5 Weeks / Week 15)

- Ensure Wix website is prepared for domain transfer
- Update DNS settings and transfer domain
- Verify security and full functionality

Supervisor Approval:

Dr. Ferrara has reviewed and approved the Design and Objectives report as shown below:



Dr. Lyndsie Ferrara

To:  Rocco Nardozzo

Start reply with:

[Thank you!](#)

[Thank you for your approval.](#)

[You are welcome.](#)

Hi Rocco,

Thank you for sharing and for reviewing this document at our meeting today. I approve this report.

Thank you,
Dr. Ferrara

From: Rocco Nardozzo <nardozzor@duq.edu>

Sent: Thursday, January 29, 2026 9:17 AM

To: Dr. Lyndsie Ferrara <schantzl@duq.edu>

Subject: COFSE Design Draft

Hi Dr. Ferrara,

I have attached the design draft that I will be reviewing with you in our meeting this afternoon just so you have a copy of it.

Thanks,
Rocco Nardozzo

 Reply

 Forward

Appendix

Figure 1:

